

The common man is undoubtedly bearing the brunt of the rising prices. But the only consolation is that it is a global phenomenon driven by the unprecedented increase in the crude oil price. And it is wrong to blame the UPA Government. Any government at the Centre would have faced this problem. However, the Government should use this crisis to plan alternative fuel for automobiles to reduce dependence on petroleum products.

S. LAKSHMI, on e-mail

Right Time to Act

The article on the much-talked about Right to Information (RTI) Act ("Open Secret", June 30) was quite bewildering. It brought forth the fact how the purpose of enactment of the RTI Act is being jeopardised by excessive bureaucratic propensity and buck-passing attitude for which the Government should either enforce punitive measures or promulgate another act with more penal actions for non-compliance.

INDU SHANKAR, Varanasi

Guru Cool

The photo-feature on the Shri Mahakaleshwar Tapobhum Vaidik Gurukul Sanskrit Vidyalaya ("The Guru Factory", June 23) not only highlighted the efforts of the Brahmin community, which is on a decline, but also drew our attention towards the ancient gurukul system. Such devoted gurus will surely help revive the ancient 'guru-shishya parampara' in the country of its origin.

MEENU GUPTA, Indore

It's A Big Deal

The Left, which has been creating a lot of hue and cry over the nuclear deal ("No Clear Deal", June 30), has failed to understand that the deal is a must for energy-starved India. It will give us access to enriched uranium, critically required to run the power-generating atomic reactors which are on the verge of shutdown. Moreover, this deal will end India's nuclear apartheid. Prime

Minister Manmohan Singh should remain firm on his stance and ensure that the deal is operationalised.

DILBAG RAI, on e-mail

The communists have been taking the Congress for a ride for a long time over the nuclear deal. This constant bickering is creating a dent in the grand old party's credibility. The party should act firmly and dissolve the marriage with the Left to revive its poll prospects.

R.J. KHURANA, Bhopal

ALL WORK AND NO PLAY



Pushing children beyond their capabilities to realise their own unfulfilled dreams is the worst form of exploitation by the parents. Such pushy parents not only spoil their children's precious childhood, but also make them confused and stressed out. It's time we parents stopped inflicting our aspirations on these hapless souls and just let them be. The best gift a parent can give its children is the roots of responsibilities and the wings of freedom to help them soar to greater heights. ("No Time for Innocence", June 30).

GAYATRI GAHLAUT, on e-mail

It's true that children have become no less than cash cows for parents, who use them to gain a foothold in the world of glamour, and for TV channels, which use them as circus artistes to boost their TRPs. Taking lesson from Shinjini Sengupta's case, who fell prey to the pressures of the reality television and lapsed into a state of depression, parents must leave their kids alone.

ROHIT KUMAR, Mumbai

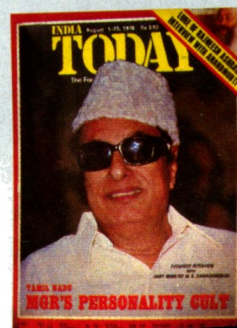
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Years Ago in India Today

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The Paper Chase

As if the ruling Janata Party leaders had not enough to cope with during what has now been termed as the "Charan Singh crisis", its leaders came under some heavy fire from the Opposition on the very first day of the Monsoon Session of Parliament. The Opposition, specially Congress (I) members, wasted little time in ramming it home to prime minister Morarji Desai by demanding that he lay before the House the correspondence between him



Desai and former home minister Charan Singh. Like the hounds thirsting for the fox's blood, the Opposition was curious enough to kill the cat to find out what Charan Singh had said about prime minister's son, Kanti Desai. But the prime minister, despite his age, withstood the onslaughts from the leader of the Opposition, C.M. Stephen who thundered: "Juridically, this House does not know the facts and it is entitled to know them from the prime minister."

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